# AF6.4 · Agents can no longer be given a human who does not exist

Agent Factory · measured 15 October 2026 · shipped in #3117 · prepared for Ali Muwwakkil

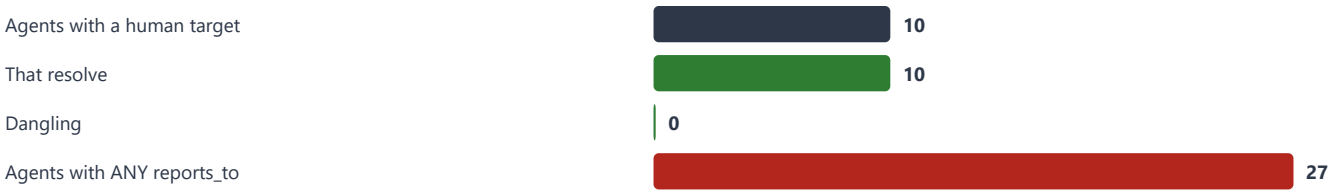
**ASKED** setAgentReportsTo does not check that the human it is given exists.

**DELIVERED** A write-path check, a test pinning the resolver as deliberately unchanged, and the measurement showing this repairs nothing and prevents something.

> **TAKEAWAY**
>
> **This closes a LATENT hole and repairs no existing damage. All 10 human targets resolve; zero dangle.**

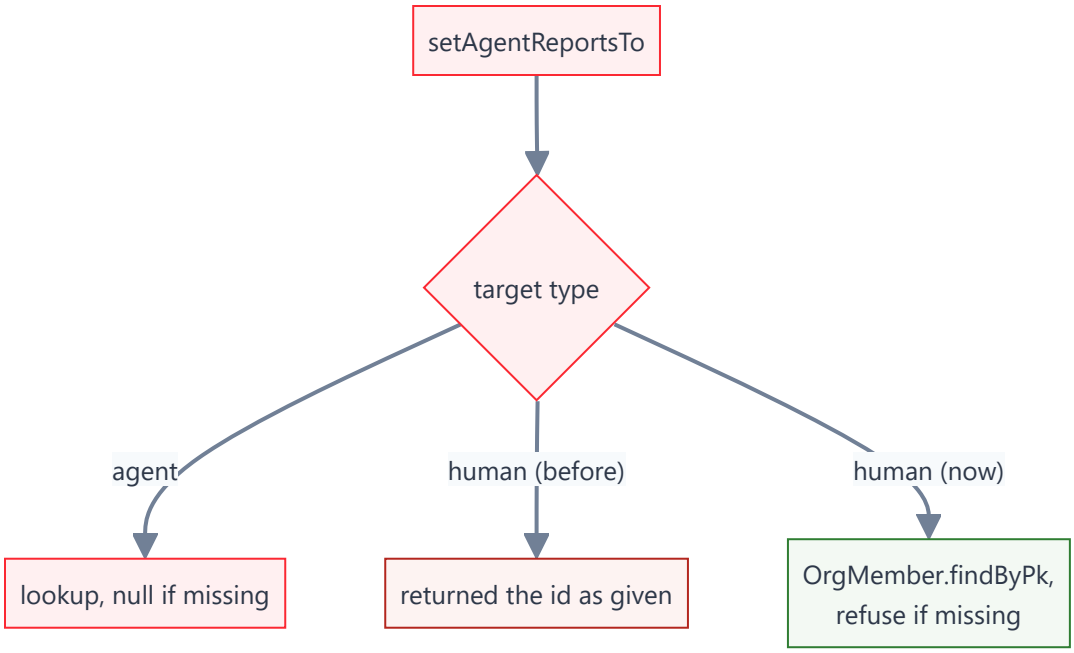
1. **The asymmetry was the bug.** An `agent` target was validated with a real lookup and returned null when dangling. A `human` target was RETURNED AS GIVEN with no lookup, so the guard rejected only an empty string.
2. **Fixed on the write path, deliberately NOT in the resolver.** The resolver is also the read path for the live ticket-creation gate; a lookup there would start refusing ticket creation for any agent whose chain already ends at a missing human. A test asserts the resolver stays clean.
3. **Said plainly because the alternative would be a claim about rows that do not exist.** "We fixed the dangling reports_to" would be false. Nothing was dangling.

## Measured




Measured against production on 15 October 2026. Bars are to scale against the largest value shown.

## How it works, or did not




The same function validated one branch and trusted the other.

## What this does not establish

- THE BIGGER FINDING IS NOT FIXED. 165 enabled agents have no reports_to at all; 126 of them have executed, 3,233,076 runs between them, led by visitor_tracker at 1,201,301. Only 27 of 257 agents have any reports_to. Ticketed as AF6.6.

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Artifact for AF6.4, filed in 06 - Owner Decisions and Blockers and attached to the ticket. Built from the same data module as the one-page visual. Backfilled on 15 October 2026 under the rule that a pull request is evidence and not an artifact.